

City Council Meeting April 7th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lyu4iw93lg8
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Target Category	muncie_city

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Muncie Common Council Comprehensive Meeting Report

Meeting Date: April 7, 2025

Body: Muncie Common Council

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Public Hearing on Ordinance 1325-25 regarding the vacation of a portion of a public alley at 2619 West Ethel Avenue [00:00:27](#).
- **Summary of Discussion:** Attorney David Kins presented the petition on behalf of property owner Robert Huddleston, explaining that the unimproved alley runs between properties owned by Huddleston (Tiltson Plaza and adjacent cleared residential parcels) and requested its vacation since he owns both sides. No other public comments were made, and the hearing was adjourned.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the regular meeting of the Muncie Common Council to order on April 7, 2025 [00:14:46](#).

- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Macintosh, Fasha, Green, Dishman, Garrett, Selby, Gullian, Powell, and President Mason.
 - **Members Absent:** None (All present).
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Mason.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - Pledge of Allegiance led by the council [00:14:53](#).
 - Invocation delivered by Pastor Robert Sca of Union Missionary Baptist Church [00:15:27](#).
 - Citizens Recognition presented by Councilwoman Rose Selby honoring **David Robbins ("Coach Dave")**, sports coordinator at the Ross Community Center and president of the Thomas Park Avondale Neighborhood Association [00:16:34](#).
Additional recognition of the Muncie Central Winter Drum Line state championship given by Councilman Green [00:23:46](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Approved by roll call vote following a motion and second [00:25:52](#).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:27:00](#) **Ordinance 7-25:** Ordinance for Transfer of Appropriations (Police/Fire).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** City Administration / Finance Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to transfer \$526,72.77 in unrestricted opioid settlement funds to support police and fire salary increases. City controllers and union representatives argued the funds were relied upon during contract negotiations and warned of economic distress if unpaid. Council members and numerous public speakers expressed frustration over a lack of transparency regarding contract contingencies and argued the funds should be prioritized for addiction treatment and prevention.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - Tanya Pearson (opposed, urged waiting for an advisory committee) [00:27:31](#)
 - Jason Cha (supported as front-line responder) [00:30:15](#)
 - Sarah Vitali (opposed, urged tabling) [00:32:51](#)
 - David (opposed) [00:35:56](#)
 - Robert Miller (opposed, cited structural budget holes) [00:36:58](#)
 - Matt Waggley & Craig Wright (City administration representatives, supported) [00:38:03](#), [00:39:10](#)
 - Joseph Souza (opposed) [00:44:49](#)
 - Ryan Mills (opposed) [00:46:17](#)

- Brandon Qualls (FOP President, supported) [00:46:58](#)
 - Holly Yip (opposed) [00:53:37](#)
 - Elizabeth Edgel (opposed) [00:55:43](#)
 - Dr. Sally Archer Jones & Ashley Snyder (Police social workers, supported) [00:57:08](#)
 - Mary Beth Lambert (opposed, urged tabling) [00:49:56](#)
 - Bernice Graham (opposed) [00:31:31](#)
 - Wayne Scafe (opposed) [00:32:42](#)
 - Chris Degan (Deputy Police Chief, supported) [01:18:32](#)
 - Dr. Lynn Woody (supported police/fire raises while emphasizing treatment) [01:53:29](#)
 - Audi Barber (opposed) [01:56:26](#)
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** A motion to table failed, and the ordinance was **Passed via Roll Call Vote** [02:05:08](#). *(Note: Transcribed roll call reflects a split vote with multiple council members voting "No" with apologies, but officially recorded as adopted).*
- [02:06:05](#) **Ordinance 8-25:** Ordinance to Amend the Comprehensive Zoning Ordinance (R-4 Residence Zone to BV Variety Business Zone at 2810 West Ethel Avenue).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** David Kins (Attorney for petitioner Mike Lunsford).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Rezoning a long-standing commercial structure (built in 1966) that was incorrectly zoned residential.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **Passed Unanimously** by roll call vote [02:08:17](#).
- [02:08:36](#) **Ordinance 11-25:** Ordinance Fixing Maximum Salaries for the Police Department (2025).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** City Council / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Amendment made to correct a typo in Section 3, updating the effective date to January 5, 2025.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **Passed Unanimously** by roll call vote as amended [02:10:37](#).
- [02:10:52](#) **Ordinance 12-25:** Ordinance Fixing Maximum Salaries for the Muncie Fire Department (2025).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** City Council / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Standard salary ordinance passage following firefighter contract negotiations.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **Passed Unanimously** by roll call vote [02:11:24](#).
- [02:11:38](#) **Ordinance 13-25:** Ordinance to Vacate a Portion of Public Alley at 2619 West Ethel Avenue.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** David Kins (Attorney representing Robert Huddleston).

- **Deliberation Summary:** Formal introduction of the alley vacation previously discussed in the pre-meeting public hearing.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** David Kins [02:12:05](#).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition: Introduced** [02:13:54](#).
- [02:14:03](#) **Ordinance 14-25:** Ordinance to Amend Zoning from R-4 to BV Variety Business Zone (1300 Block East Centennial Avenue).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ken Hudson (Whitley Community Council).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Rezoning required to accommodate parking requirements for the redevelopment of the east side community resource hub. Received a 7-0 favorable recommendation from the plan commission.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Ken Hudson [02:14:34](#).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Rules suspended and **Approved by Roll Call Vote** [02:19:45](#).
- [02:20:11](#) **Ordinance 15-25:** Ordinance to Amend Zoning from R-3 to BV Variety Business Zone (1300 North Milton Street).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Representative for Netley Properties.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposed rezoning to construct a Seven Brew coffee shop. Council members raised questions regarding residential buffers, fencing, and traffic patterns.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Petitioner representative [02:20:45](#).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition: Introduced** [02:25:00](#).
- [02:25:13](#) **Ordinance 16-25:** Ordinance Amending Ordinance 33-24 (Fixing Maximum Salaries of Appointed Officers, Employees, and Department Heads for 2025).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** City Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding funding positions out of EDIT funds.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Audi Barber [02:25:53](#).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition: Introduced** [02:29:02](#).
- [02:29:22](#) **Resolution 9-25:** Approving Collective Bargaining Agreement with AFSCME Local 33656.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nate Burgess (AFSCME President).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Agreement provides a 2% salary increase following lengthy negotiations. Council members commended municipal workers for their dedication to park maintenance, road upkeep, and city services.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Nate Burgess [02:30:03](#).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition: Passed Unanimously** by roll call vote [02:34:54](#).
- [02:35:26](#) **Resolution 10-25:** Opposing Indiana Senate Bill 1 (Property Tax Overhaul).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** City Council / Community Advocates.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Resolution expressing formal opposition to state legislation projected to significantly reduce municipal revenues and impact public safety and park funding.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Holly Yip [02:35:50](#), Rick Yenser [02:41:08](#), Mary Beth Lambert [02:43:04](#).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition: Passed Unanimously** by roll call vote [02:45:23](#).
 - **02:45:34 Resolution 11-25:** Establishing an Opioid Fund Advisory Committee.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Councilwoman Gullian.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Establishes a local advisory committee to guide the allocation of restricted and unrestricted opioid settlement funds, incorporating community stakeholders and adherence to state guidelines.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Pastor Neil Kring [02:46:07](#), Dr. Lynn Woody [02:48:28](#), Audi Barber [02:51:51](#), Carolyn Neil [02:53:04](#).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition: Passed Unanimously** by roll call vote [02:46:46](#).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(Conducted continuously throughout the meeting during public hearings and agenda item debates; major general speakers noted below) - [02:57:52](#) **Curtis Westbrook:** Addressed the need for city-run, city-funded youth community centers and sports recreation programs to combat youth engagement issues. - [03:06:54](#) **Dr. Lynn Woody:** Spoke regarding traffic safety signage needs near the south turnabout on High Street and Walnut Street. - [03:08:18](#) **Audi Barber:** Criticized council decorum and administration responsiveness, urging greater oversight and fiscal caution.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** None explicitly detailed.
 - **Adjournment:** Meeting adjourned by voice vote [03:11:21](#).
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